



The power to do more

Dell SupportAssist

Frequently Asked Questions

Dell SupportAssist is proactive, automated support technology integrated into our suite of enterprise products and systems management consoles to enable faster resolution and reporting. SupportAssist includes remote monitoring, automated data collection, automatic case creation and proactive contact from Dell tech support. This capability is available on select Dell™ PowerEdge™ servers, EqualLogic Storage Arrays, PowerVault™ storage, PowerConnect™ and Force10™ covered under a [Dell ProSupport™ contract](#).

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What is Dell SupportAssist?

Bundled with Dell systems management consoles, it is a downloadable application that enables transparent visibility to your Dell server, storage, and networking infrastructure, proactively identifies failures in your IT environment and immediately alerts you and Dell to initiate resolution. Available with hardware warranty and ProSupport suite entitlements on system (service tag), Dell SupportAssist designed with our customers in mind to provide an enhanced support experience.

How do I get it?

OpenManage™ Essentials (OME) download is available [here](#) and includes SupportAssist. To download just the new features in SupportAssist, the latest version of SupportAssist for OME download is available [here](#).

How much does it cost?

The new tool is available at no additional charge with Dell ProSupport service entitlement. If you choose to install SupportAssist yourself, you can receive expert assistance from Dell technical support at no extra charge. However, if you would like Dell to install the software and do an initial discovery of your systems, a fee-based remote installation is available.

What is the language support for Dell SupportAssist?

Dell SupportAssist software user interface will support all of the languages supported by OME today. These include: English, German, French, Spanish, Simplified Chinese, and Japanese. In addition, the user may choose 1 of 28 languages for auto-email notification sent at time of service request incident. Users may select language desired in software under the preferences settings.

Which systems are supported?

All ninth-generation or newer select Dell™ PowerEdge™ servers, EqualLogic Storage Arrays, PowerVault™ storage, PowerConnect™ and Force10™ networking equipment covered under a [Dell ProSupport™ contract](#). For additional models supported, refer to the [support matrix document](#) on our Dell Community Group site.

Which countries is SupportAssist available in?

SupportAssist auto email notifications, at time of critical alert on device service tag, are dependent on user having SupportAssist active. Service tag support entitlement and country availability of ProSupport offering apply at time of auto email notification.

What are the installation requirements for the Dell SupportAssist plug-in for OpenManage Essentials?

The software must be installed on a system running Windows Server 2008 R2 operating systems, using Administrator privileges.

What are the system requirements for monitored devices?

Dell SupportAssist can monitor Dell PowerEdge™ servers with Dell OpenManage™ Server Administrator (OMSA) 5.0 or later installed. SupportAssist can monitor 12G servers without OMSA agent. For additional information, refer to the [support matrix document](#) available on our Community Group site.

What are the bandwidth requirements for the SupportAssist plug-in?

The bandwidth requirement (both local and external) is usually less than or equal to 20 Kbps. For networks with T1 or greater capacity, bandwidth usage should have a negligible impact on overall traffic.

Why doesn't Dell SupportAssist currently support Compellent?

Currently, Compellent already has a self-contained integrated support solution that is easy to set up and requires few deployment resources. This existing solution will be integrated, but not replaced, within future versions of Dell SupportAssist.

Do I need to enable SupportAssist for Equallogic arrays in SAN Headquarters (SAN HQ)?

SAN HQ v2.6 and v3.0 releases include SupportAssist feature for opening support cases – currently limited to a few common cases such as hard drive failures- for an array with ProSupport. SAN HQ is highly recommended for customers managing EqualLogic storage arrays. To get additional reporting and recommendation features available with ProSupport Plus, the use of SupportAssist for OpenManage Essentials (OME) is also needed and highly recommended for customers with PowerEdge, PowerVault, Force10 and PowerConnect networking. Dell Technical Support responds to support case service requests via SupportAssist in the same manner, whether from SAN HQ and/or OME systems management consoles.

Which hardware faults does SupportAssist monitor?

SupportAssist has a smart hardware fault monitoring algorithm with thresholds to avoid false positives and duplication of actions. Not all hardware faults have immediate response actions. They are compared to persistent fault threshold values prior to responding with defined actions. Defined response actions include case creation, diagnostic execution and log attachment. On Dell PowerEdge servers, the Dell SupportAssist can monitor roughly 100

hardware fault events. These faults include memory, disk, power supply, controller and other component failures. On Dell PowerVault and EqualLogic storage devices, SupportAssist can monitor such faults as disks, controllers, power supplies, cache batteries and other component failures. On Dell PowerConnect and Force10 switches, SupportAssist can monitor faults such as link failures or rising temperatures.

What happens on hardware faults?

When a fault occurs on a system with active ProSupport entitlement, Dell SupportAssist opens a new case with Dell technical support. You receive an email notification containing the case number for that Service Tag, and then a support technician contacts you to resolve the issue. All subsequent faults on that Service Tag are appended to the same case until issues are resolved and case is closed.

How does Dell SupportAssist save me time during the troubleshooting process?

SupportAssist automatically detects issues, captures diagnostics data and initiates alerts and call from Dell. You will eliminate time spent on collecting data, case creation and engaging with Dell. If you choose to disable the automatic diagnostics, you can still use Dell SupportAssist to run the diagnostics on demand and to automatically send the data to Dell.

What happens to the Dell SupportAssist features when ProSupport coverage on my monitored systems expires?

If you allow your Dell ProSupport service contract to expire, the automatic case creation feature will get disabled. You will continue to receive notifications from SupportAssist on hardware faults and the OpenManage Essentials plug-in will show you the critical alerts generated by hardware that needs attention. After you extend your ProSupport contract entitlement on system (service tag), the automatic case creation will enable automatically on that system.

What are the limitations to the install base for customers using SupportAssist with ProSupport Plus for data collection?

In an environment that consists of less than 300 devices, the network bandwidth consumed for uploading the system log collection is about 4 MB/second. Disabling the scheduling of system log collection for a specific device type only disables the generation of system log collection at periodic intervals on those devices. It does not disable SupportAssist from generating a system log collection and uploading it to Dell, if a support case is opened for those devices. For customers with more than 300 devices or for additional questions, please refer to the [User Guide](#) or [Quick Start Guide](#).

Security and Data Protection

Which types of data does the Dell SupportAssist collect?

The Dell SupportAssist collects system attributes and basic performance data. System attributes include the make, model, service tag, and OS. The application does not collect any files stored on the system, any passwords or any information about application usage. Exceptions are, automated diagnostics log files and SupportAssist error log.

Can Dell staff (such as account representatives, support technicians and service delivery managers) access the information?

Not at this time, however, Dell is working on reporting to make information from Dell SupportAssist available to authorized Dell team members.

How is my data protected?

- **SupportAssist uses SSL encryption while sending data from customer premises to Dell.** Dell hosts SupportAssist data — including the application, systems, network and security components — in a US-based data center designed to maintain high levels of availability and security. Dell protects your data by using a wide variety of measures, including:
 - **Physical security** — Features include, but are not limited to:
 - On-premises security guards
 - Rigorous exterior building security, including cameras, false entrances, vehicle blockades, specialized parking lot design, bulletproof glass and walls, and the use of an unmarked building
 - Interior pan/tilt/zoom security cameras with digital recorders
 - Network security — All monitoring components are located behind a firewall and are managed by a Dell network security team. We tightly control all network traffic, requiring all inbound traffic to be transmitted via specific ports and sent only to appropriate destination network addresses.
 - **Server and database security** — Servers and OS components reside on standard images that have undergone security review. We regularly review security updates used by the application, including those published by Microsoft and vendors of other software. When critical security updates are issued, we test them first on nonproduction images and generally apply them to live servers within 48 hours.
 - **Procedural security** — Dell groups who have access to Dell SupportAssist components (such as the database administration group and the operational support team) are assigned separate duties and access rights. All updates to the production environment go through a defined change control process that incorporates checks and balances.
 - **Auditing** — Dell retains proprietary monitoring hosting device logs, accessible only by Dell. These logs record all attempts to log into or access the OS or SupportAssist Web Server Console, as well as every write or escalation operation performed by an authenticated user on the Server Console.

How do I get assistance deploying OpenManage Essentials and SupportAssist?

Many customers download and install OpenManage Essentials (OME) and SupportAssist without assistance from Dell; however, if you do not have the time or resources, you can utilize the Dell Remote Consulting Services (RCS) to implement SupportAssist. RCS includes deployment and setup by a Dell Support Engineer over the phone using a secure Internet connection. RCS will assist you with the following tasks:

- OpenManage Essentials and SupportAssist set-up on the management server.
- OpenManage Server Assistant (OMSA) set-up on additional devices to be monitored.

- Note: Deployment of Microsoft SCOM is not included in RCS. However, RCS does include assistance with the SupportAssist SCOM plugin software and OMSA on monitored devices.

You can order and utilize RCS by one of the following methods:

1. If you have devices with a ProSupport or ProSupport Plus entitlement, you may contact your Technical Account Manager for additional information.
2. You may contact your Dell Sales Representative for a quote and to order RCS.
3. If you have an existing order number with RCS, you may contact Dell Technical Support to schedule an implementation time.

When you order RCS, a specific service description will be reviewed with you. For more information on the service description, see the [Remote Consulting Service document](#).

If your IT Administrator has already implemented OpenManage Essentials (or Microsoft SCOM), installing and setting up SupportAssist requires approximately 15 minutes. You may need additional time to verify that OpenManage Essentials (or Microsoft SCOM) is set up properly to send alerts via SNMP and that SupportAssist is set up to upload collections to Dell.

What if I need onsite assistance deploying OpenManage Essentials or Microsoft SCOM and the SupportAssist plugin?

If you need assistance beyond our Remote Consulting Service (RCS) offering, you may request a custom bid for on-site assistance through your Dell Sales representative. Please include the following information in your request:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ✓ Country | ✓ Number of Dell server, storage, and networking devices to be monitored |
| ✓ City | ✓ Operating system software being used |
| ✓ Language preference for software installation (English, French, German, Spanish, Simplified Chinese, or Japanese) | ✓ Estimated budget and timeframe for deployment |

If you are requesting on-site assistance with SupportAssist for Microsoft SCOM, you may work with your Dell Sales representative to connect to the appropriate Dell Consulting team for deployment services.

The SupportAssist team continually strives to better understand your business needs. Including the reason why Remote Consulting Services (RCS) does not meet your business needs within your custom bid request will help us better serve you in the future.

What if I need assistance configuring Dell Storage devices or Dell Networking switches only?

The following [technical white papers](#) provide specific steps and information on configuring Dell Storage devices, Networking switches and PowerEdge servers with iDRAC:

- Monitoring iDRAC7 Devices
- Force10 ethernet switches
- PowerConnect ethernet switches
- PowerVault MD Series Storage Arrays,
- Dell EqualLogic Storage Arrays
- EqualLogic Storage Hosting a Fluid File System

For more information, additional resource documents are available at [SupportAssist manuals](#).

NOTE: For Windows users, the *Managing Windows Device Credentials in SupportAssist Using Service Account* document is available.

What notifications are new with SupportAssist for OME 2.0?

With the 2.0 release in September 2014, new error and corrective action messages are displayed in SupportAssist. These messages are also sent to the customer via automatic emails.

For a customer that chooses to use the diagnostic collection function, a “Dell SupportAssist - Collection alert” email will be sent if an issue occurs with collection uploads sent to Technical Support.

Customers with a local Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP) email server in their environment can configure SupportAssist to notify them of issues with their device and connectivity statuses. An email notification is sent through the local SMTP server with the subject line “Dell SupportAssist OME – Connectivity alert”, “Connectivity alert – CRITICAL”, or “Device validation alert”.

- Inactive accounts will receive an email with the subject line “Your Dell SupportAssist account appears inactive”. Accounts that have been inactive for 30 days receive this email. This communication includes a link to the Dell SupportAssist Community for video tutorials, peer-to-peer questions, User Guides and an option to download the latest SupportAssist release. Possible reasons for inactivity include the following:
 - An uninstalled and reinstalled plugin.
 - A plugin is not communicating with the server due to proxy credentials or network issues.
 - No devices have been discovered by SupportAssist in the past 30 days.

The SupportAssist for OME 2.0 email notifications are listed below.

Email subject line	Reason for receiving email
Welcome to Dell SupportAssist	Upon 1 st time registration with Dell
Dell SupportAssist - Hardware alert detected, case created	Service tag with ProSupport
Dell SupportAssist - Hardware alert detected	Service tag with Basic or Expired
Dell SupportAssist - Hardware alert detected	Technical difficulty, but no support case
Dell SupportAssist – Collection alert	Diagnostic collection issue occurred
Your Dell SupportAssist account appears inactive	When inactive 30 or more days

The additional emails below are sent when SupportAssist set-up includes a local SMTP email server (optional).

Email subject line	Reason for receiving email
Dell SupportAssist OME – Device validation alert	RE: availability of device on network, connection or log collections
Dell SupportAssist OME – Connectivity alert	RE: Dependency on Internet, Local SMTP e-mail server, Dell FTP server, OME service, or Dell servers for SupportAssist
Dell SupportAssist OME – Connectivity alert - CRITICAL	

Additional automatic email information is available in the SupportAssist User Guide found within the SupportAssist application and in the [SupportAssist manuals](#).

Which Alerts open support cases with Dell Technical Support?

A full list of alerts that open support cases is available in the *Dell SupportAssist: Alert Policy* technical white paper posted at [SupportAssist manuals](#).

Is SupportAssist a replacement for remote monitoring service?

SupportAssist is not a remote monitoring service. Systems management software, such as OpenManage Essentials or Microsoft SCOM, monitors and receives alerts from managed devices. SupportAssist monitors the alerts received by the systems management console and automatically creates a support case based on Dell pre-defined alert thresholds. A support case is created only for hardware alerts that would have been most likely to create a support case when a customer contacts Dell Technical Support.

The goal is to automate and thereby accelerate the process for opening support cases with Dell Technical Support, when potential hardware issues arise. It is not a replacement for IT staff, which has responsibility for systems management and hardware uptime; but rather, it is a complementary resource to augment a customer's capabilities, especially for those that are ProSupport or ProSupport Plus entitled.